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Archaeological evidence indicates some of the oldest stone implements found at Colha were used to cut away vegetation after controlled burning of trees to open areas of swampland for cultivation.

•

Successor cultures at a given site often adopt the style of agricultural implements used by earlier inhabitants of the same site.

•

Many religious and social institutions of the Mayan people who inhabited Colha 3,000 years ago relied on a highly developed system of agricultural symbols.

Questions 739–802 — Difficulty: Hard

739. Duckbill dinosaurs, like today's monitor lizards, had particularly long tails, which they could whip at considerable speed. Monitor lizards use their tails to strike predators. However, although duckbill tails were otherwise very similar to those of monitor lizards, the duckbill's tailbones were proportionately much thinner and thus more delicate. Moreover, to ward off their proportionately much larger predators, duckbills would have had to whip their tails considerably faster than monitor lizards do.

The information given, if accurate, provides the strongest support for which of the following hypotheses?

A. If duckbills whipped their tails faster than monitor lizards do, the duckbill's tail would have been effective at warding off the duckbills' fiercest predators.

B. Duckbills used their tails to strike predators, and their tailbones were frequently damaged from the impact.

C. Using their tails was not the only means duckbills had for warding off predators.

D. Duckbills were at much greater risk of being killed by a predator than monitor lizards are.

E. The tails of duckbills, if used to ward off predators, would have been more likely than the tails of monitor lizards to sustain damage from the impact.

740. In an attempt to produce a coffee plant that would yield beans containing no caffeine, the synthesis of a substance known to be integral to the initial stages of caffeine production was blocked either in the beans, in the leaves, or both. For those plants in which synthesis of the substance was blocked only in the leaves, the resulting beans contained no caffeine.

Any of the following, if true, would provide the basis for an explanation of the observed results EXCEPT:

A. In coffee plants, the substance is synthesized only in the leaves and then moves to the beans, where the initial stages of caffeine production take place.

B. In coffee plants, the last stage of caffeine production takes place in the beans using a compound that is produced only in the leaves by the substance.

C. In coffee plants, the initial stages of caffeine production take place only in the beans, but later stages depend on another substance that is synthesized only in the leaves and does not depend on the blocked substance.

D. In coffee plants, caffeine production takes place only in the leaves, but the caffeine then moves to the beans.

E. Caffeine was produced in the beans of the modified coffee plants, but all of it moved to the leaves, which normally produce their own caffeine.

741. Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

Laminated glass is much harder to break than the glass typically used in the windows of cars driven in Relnia. It is more difficult for thieves to break into cars with laminated glass windows than into cars with ordinary glass windows, and laminated glass windows are less likely to break in a collision. Nevertheless, considerations of security and safety do not unambiguously support a proposal to require that in Relnia all glass installed in cars be laminated glass, since _____.

A. most people cannot visually distinguish laminated glass from the glass typically used for car windows

B. a significant proportion of cars driven in Relnia are manufactured elsewhere

C. some cars in Relnia already have laminated glass in their windows

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D. the rates of car theft and of collisions have both fallen slightly in Relnia in recent years

E. there are times when breaking a car's window is the best way to provide timely help for people trapped inside

742. Consultant: **Ace Repairs ends up having to redo a significant number of the complex repair jobs it undertakes, but when those repairs are redone, they are invariably done right.** Since we have established that there is no systematic difference between the mechanics who are assigned to do the initial repairs and those who are assigned to redo unsatisfactory jobs, we must reject the hypothesis that mistakes made in the initial repairs are due to the mechanics' lack of competence. Rather, it is likely that **complex repairs require a level of focused attention that the company's mechanics apply consistently only to repair jobs that have not been done right on the first try.**

In the consultant's reasoning, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is the consultant's main conclusion; the second provides evidence in support of that main conclusion.

B. The first is evidence that serves as the basis for rejecting one explanation of a certain finding; the second is the consultant's own explanation of that finding.

C. The first is a claim whose truth is at issue in the reasoning; the second provides evidence to show that the claim is true.

D. The first presents a contrast whose explanation is at issue in the reasoning; the second is the consultant's explanation of that contrast.

E. The first presents a contrast whose explanation is at issue in the reasoning; the second is evidence that has been used to challenge the consultant's explanation of that contrast.

743. To reduce waste of raw materials, the government of Sperland is considering requiring household appliances to be broken down for salvage when discarded. To cover the cost of salvage, the government is planning to charge a fee, which would be imposed when the appliance is first sold. Imposing the fee at the time of salvage would reduce waste more effectively, however, because consumers tend to keep old appliances longer if they are faced with a fee for discarding them.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Increasing the cost of disposing of an appliance properly increases the incentive to dispose of it improperly.

B. The fee provides manufacturers with no incentive to produce appliances that are more durable.

C. For people who have bought new appliances recently, the salvage fee would not need to be paid for a number of years.

D. People who sell their used, working appliances to others would not need to pay the salvage fee.

E. Many nonfunctioning appliances that are currently discarded could be repaired at relatively little expense.

744. Twelve years ago and again five years ago, there were extended periods when the Changir Republic's currency, the pundra, was weak: Its value was unusually low relative to the world's most stable currencies. Both times, a weak pundra made Changir's manufactured products a bargain on world markets, and Changir's exports were up substantially. Now some politicians are saying in order to cause another similarly sized increase in exports, the government should allow the pundra to become weak again.

Which of the following, if true, provides the government with the strongest grounds to doubt that if followed, the politicians' recommendation will achieve its aim?

A. Several of the politicians now recommending the pundra be allowed to become weak made that same recommendation before each of the last two periods of currency weakness.

B. After several decades of operating well below peak capacity, Changir's manufacturing sector is now operating at near-peak levels.

C. The economy of a country experiencing a rise in exports will become healthier only if the country's currency is strong or the rise in exports is significant.

D. Those countries with manufactured products competing with Changir's on the world market all currently have stable currencies.

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E. A sharp improvement in the efficiency of Changir's manufacturing plants would make Changir's products a bargain in world markets even without any weakening of the pundra relative to other currencies.

745. Increased use of incineration is sometimes advocated as a safe way to dispose of chemical waste. But opponents of incineration point to the 40 incidents involving unexpected releases of dangerous chemical agents that were reported just last year at two existing incinerators commissioned to destroy a quantity of chemical waste material. Since designs for proposed new incinerators include no additional means of preventing such releases, leaks will only become more prevalent if use of incineration increases.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. At the two incinerators at which leaks were reported, staff had had only cursory training on the proper procedures for incinerating chemical waste.

B. Other means of disposing of chemical waste, such as chemical neutralization processes, have not been proven safer than incineration.

C. The capacity of existing incinerators is sufficient to allow for increased incineration of chemical waste without any need for new incinerators.

D. The frequency of reports of unexpected releases of chemical agents at newly built incinerators is about the same as the frequency at older incinerators.

E. In only three of the reported incidents of unexpected chemical leaks did the releases extend outside the property on which the incinerators were located.

746. Public health expert: **Increasing the urgency of a public health message may be counterproductive.** In addition to irritating the majority who already behave responsibly, **it may undermine all government pronouncements on health by convincing people that such messages are overly cautious.** And there is no reason to believe that those who ignore measured voices will listen to shouting.

The two sections in **boldface** play which of the following roles in the public health expert's argument?

A. The first is a conclusion for which support is provided, but it is not the argument's main conclusion; the second is an unsupported premise supporting the argument's main conclusion.

B. The first is a premise supporting the only explicit conclusion; so is the second.

C. The first is the argument's main conclusion; the second supports that conclusion and is itself a conclusion for which support is provided.

D. The first is a premise supporting the argument's only conclusion; the second is that conclusion.

E. The first is the argument's only explicit conclusion; the second is a premise supporting that conclusion.

747. Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

A new machine for harvesting corn will allow rows to be planted only 15 inches apart instead of the usual 30 inches. Corn planted this closely will produce lower yields per plant. Nevertheless, the new machine will allow corn growers to double their profits per acre because _____.

A. with the closer spacing of the rows, the growing corn plants will quickly form a dense canopy of leaves, which by shading the ground will minimize the need for costly weed control and irrigation

B. with the closer spacing of the rows, corn plants will be forced to grow taller because of increased competition for sunlight from neighboring corn plants

C. with the larger number of plants growing per acre, more fertilizer will be required

D. with the spacing between rows cut by half, the number of plants grown per acre will almost double

E. with the closer spacing of the rows, the acreage on which corn is planted will be utilized much more intensively than it was before, requiring more frequent fallow years in which corn fields are left unplanted

748. The difference in average annual income in favor of employees who have college degrees, compared with those who do not have such degrees, doubled between 1980 and 1990. Some analysts have hypothesized that increased competition between employers for employees with college degrees drove up income for such employees.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the explanation described above?

A. During the 1980s a growing percentage of college graduates, unable to find jobs requiring a college degree, took unskilled jobs.

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took unskilled jobs.

B. The average age of all employees increased slightly during the 1980s.

C. The unemployment rate changed very little throughout most of the 1980s.

D. From 1980 to 1990, the difference in average income between employees with advanced degrees and those with bachelor's degrees also increased.

E. During the 1980s there were some employees with no college degree who earned incomes comparable to the top incomes earned by employees with a college degree.

749. Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

According to the last pre-election poll in Whippleton, most voters believe that the three problems government needs to address, in order of importance, are pollution, crime, and unemployment. Yet in the election, candidates from parties perceived as strongly against pollution were defeated, while those elected were all from parties with a history of opposing legislation designed to reduce pollution. These results should not be taken to indicate that the poll was inaccurate, however, since _____.

A. some voters in Whippleton do not believe that pollution needs to be reduced

B. every candidate who was defeated had a strong antipollution record

C. there were no issues other than crime, unemployment, and pollution on which the candidates had significant differences of opinion

D. all the candidates who were elected were perceived as being stronger against both crime and unemployment than the candidates who were defeated

E. many of the people who voted in the election refused to participate in the poll

750. Manufacturing plants in Arundia have recently been acquired in substantial numbers by investors from abroad. Arundian politicians are proposing legislative action to stop such investment, justifying the proposal by arguing that foreign investors, opportunistically exploiting a recent fall in the value of the Arundian currency, were able to buy Arundian assets at less than their true value.

Which of the following, if true, casts the most serious doubt on the adequacy of the Arundian politicians' justification for the proposed legislation?

A. The Arundian government originally welcomed the fall in the value of the Arundian currency because the fall made Arundian exports more competitive on international markets.

B. Foreign investors who acquired Arundian manufacturing plants generally did so with no intention of keeping and running those plants over the long term.

C. Without the recent fall in the value of the Arundian currency, many of the Arundian assets bought by foreign investors would have been beyond the financial reach of those investors.

D. In Concordia, a country broadly similar to Arundia, the share of manufacturing assets that is foreign-controlled is 60 percent higher than it is in Arundia.

E. The true value of an investment is determined by the value of the profits from it, and the low value of the Arundian currency has depressed the value of any profits earned by foreign investors from Arundian assets.

751. Proposal: Carbon dioxide and methane in the atmosphere block the escape of heat into space. So emission of these "greenhouse" gases contributes to global warming. In order to reduce global warming, emission of greenhouse gases needs to be reduced. Therefore, the methane now emitted from open landfills should instead be burned to produce electricity.

Objection: The burning of methane generates carbon dioxide that is released into the atmosphere.

Which of the following, if true, most adequately counters the objection made to the proposal?

A. Every time a human being or other mammal exhales, there is some carbon dioxide released into the air.

B. The conversion of methane to electricity would occur at a considerable distance from the landfills.

C. The methane that is used to generate electricity would generally be used as a substitute for a fuel that does not produce any greenhouse gases when burned.

D. Methane in the atmosphere is more effective in blocking the escape of heat from the Earth than is carbon dioxide.

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dioxide.

E. The amount of methane emitted from the landfills could be reduced if the materials whose decomposition produces methane were not discarded but recycled.

752. Proposed new safety rules for Beach City airport would lengthen considerably the minimum time between takeoffs from the airport. In consequence, the airport would be able to accommodate 10 percent fewer flights than currently use the airport daily. The city's operating budget depends heavily on taxes generated by tourist spending, and most of the tourists come by plane. Therefore, the proposed new safety rules, if adopted, will reduce the revenue available for the operating budget.

The argument depends on assuming which of the following?

A. There are no periods of the day during which the interval between flights taking off from the airport is significantly greater than the currently allowed minimum.

B. Few, if any, of the tourists who use Beach City airport do so when their main destination is a neighboring community and not Beach City itself.

C. If the proposed safety rules are adopted, the reduction in tourist numbers will not result mainly from a reduction in the number of tourists who spend relatively little in Beach City.

D. Increasing the minimum time between takeoffs is the only way to achieve necessary safety improvements without a large expenditure by the city government on airport enhancements.

E. The response to the adoption of the new safety rules would not include a large increase in the number of passengers per flight.

753. The introduction of new drugs into the market is frequently prevented by a shortage of human subjects for the clinical trials needed to show that the drugs are safe and effective. Since the lives and health of people in future generations may depend on treatments that are currently experimental, practicing physicians are morally in the wrong when, in the absence of any treatment proven to be effective, they fail to encourage suitable patients to volunteer for clinical trials.

Which of the following, if true, casts most doubt on the conclusion of the argument?

A. Many drugs undergoing clinical trials are intended for the treatment of conditions for which there is currently no effective treatment.

B. Patients do not share the physician's professional concern for public health, but everyone has a moral obligation to alleviate suffering when able to do so.

C. Usually, half the patients in a clinical trial serve as a control group and receive a nonactive drug in place of the drug being tested.

D. An experimental drug cannot legally be made available to patients unless those patients are subjects in clinical trials of the drug.

E. Physicians have an overriding moral and legal duty to care for the health and safety of their current patients.

754. As a construction material, bamboo is as strong as steel and sturdier than concrete. Moreover, in tropical areas, bamboo is a much less expensive construction material than either steel or concrete and is always readily available. In tropical areas, therefore, building with bamboo makes better economic sense than building with steel or concrete, except where land values are high.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the exception noted above?

A. Buildings constructed of bamboo are less likely to suffer earthquake damage than are steel and concrete buildings.

B. Bamboo is unsuitable as a building material for multistory buildings.

C. In order to protect it from being damaged by termites and beetles, bamboo must be soaked, at some expense, in a preservative.

D. In some tropical areas, bamboo is used to make the scaffolding that is used during large construction projects.

E. Bamboo growing in an area where land values are increasing is often cleared to make way for construction.

755. The country of Virodia has, until now, been barely self-sufficient in both meat and grain. Greater prosperity there has gone hand in hand with steadily increasing per capita consumption of meat, and it takes several pounds of

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has gone hand in hand with steadily increasing per capita consumption of meat, and it takes several pounds of grain used as feed to produce one pound of meat. Per capita income is almost certain to rise further, yet increases in domestic grain production are unlikely.

Which of the following is most strongly supported by the information given?

A. Some land in Virodia that is currently used for grain production will soon be turned into pastureland for grazing cattle for meat.

B. In the future, per capita income in Virodia is unlikely to increase as rapidly as it has in the past.

C. In Virodia, the amount of grain it takes to produce one pound of meat is likely to increase in coming years.

D. Grain is soon likely to make up a larger proportion of the average Virodian's diet than ever before.

E. Virodia is likely to become an importer of grain or meat or both.

756. Newspaper editors should not allow reporters to write the headlines for their own stories. The reason for this is that, while the headlines that reporters themselves write are often clever, what typically makes them clever is that they allude to little-known information that is familiar to the reporter but that never appears explicitly in the story itself.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. The reporter who writes a story is usually better placed than the reporter's editor is to judge what the story's most newsworthy features are.

B. To write a headline that is clever, a person must have sufficient understanding of the story that the headline accompanies.

C. Most reporters rarely bother to find out how other reporters have written stories and headlines about the same events that they themselves have covered.

D. For virtually any story that a reporter writes, there are at least a few people who know more about the story's subject matter than does the reporter.

E. The kind of headlines that newspaper editors want are those that anyone who has read a reporter's story in its entirety will recognize as clever.

757. Advertisement: Our competitors' computer salespeople are paid according to the value of the products they sell, so they have a financial incentive to convince you to buy the most expensive units—whether you need them or not. But here at Comput-o-Mart, our salespeople are paid a salary that is not dependent on the value of their sales, so they won't try to tell you what to buy. That means when you buy a computer at Comput-o-Mart, you can be sure you're not paying for computing capabilities you don't need.

Which of the following would, if true, most weaken the advertisement's reasoning?

A. Some less-expensive computers actually have greater computing power than more expensive ones.

B. Salespeople who have a financial incentive to make sales generally provide more attentive service than do other salespeople.

C. Extended warranties purchased for less-expensive computers can cost nearly as much as the purchase price of the computer.

D. Comput-o-Mart is open only limited hours, which makes it more difficult for many shoppers to buy computers there than at other retail stores.

E. Comput-o-Mart does not sell any computers that support only basic computing.

758. Proponents of the recently introduced tax on sales of new luxury boats had argued that a tax of this sort would be an equitable way to increase government revenue because the admittedly heavy tax burden would fall only on wealthy people, and neither they nor anyone else would suffer any economic hardship. In fact, however, 20 percent of the workers employed by manufacturers of luxury boats have lost their jobs as a direct result of this tax.

The information given, if true, most strongly supports which of the following?

A. The market for luxury boats would have collapsed even if the new tax on luxury boats had been lower.

B. The new tax would produce a net gain in tax revenue for the government only if the yearly total revenue that it generates exceeds the total of any yearly tax-revenue decrease resulting from the workers' loss of jobs.

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jobs.

C. Because many people never buy luxury items, imposing a sales tax on luxury items is the kind of legislative action that does not cost incumbent legislators much popular support.

D. Before the tax was instituted, luxury boats were largely bought by people who were not wealthy.

E. Taxes can be equitable only if their burden is evenly distributed over the entire population.

759. In Wareland last year, 16 percent of licensed drivers under 21 and 11 percent of drivers ages 21–24 were in serious accidents. By contrast, only 3 percent of licensed drivers 65 and older were involved in serious accidents. These figures clearly show that the greater experience and developed habits of caution possessed by drivers in the 65-and-older group make them far safer behind the wheel than the younger drivers are.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Drivers 65 and older do not, on average, drive very many fewer miles per year than drivers 24 and younger.

B. Drivers 65 and older do not constitute a significantly larger percentage of licensed drivers in Wareland than drivers ages 18–24 do.

C. Drivers 65 and older are less likely than are drivers 24 and younger to drive during weather conditions that greatly increase the risk of accidents.

D. The difference between the accident rate of drivers under 21 and of those ages 21–24 is attributable to the greater driving experience of those in the older group.

E. There is no age bracket for which the accident rate is lower than it is for licensed drivers 65 and older.

760. In the past, the country of Malvernia has relied heavily on imported oil. Malvernia recently implemented a program to convert heating systems from oil to natural gas. Malvernia currently produces more natural gas each year than it uses, and oil production in Malvernian oil fields is increasing at a steady pace. If these trends in fuel production and usage continue, therefore, Malvernian reliance on foreign sources for fuel is likely to decline soon.

Which of the following would it be most useful to establish in evaluating the argument?

A. When, if ever, will production of oil in Malvernia outstrip production of natural gas?

B. Is Malvernia among the countries that rely most on imported oil?

C. What proportion of Malvernia's total energy needs is met by hydroelectric, solar, and nuclear power?

D. Is the amount of oil used each year in Malvernia for generating electricity and fuel for transportation increasing?

E. Have any existing oil-burning heating systems in Malvernia already been converted to natural-gas-burning heating systems?

761. Exposure to certain chemicals commonly used in elementary schools as cleaners or pesticides causes allergic reactions in some children. Elementary school nurses in Renston report that the proportion of schoolchildren sent to them for treatment of allergic reactions to those chemicals has increased significantly over the past ten years. Therefore, either Renston's schoolchildren have been exposed to greater quantities of the chemicals or they are more sensitive to them than schoolchildren were ten years ago.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. The number of school nurses employed by Renston's elementary schools has not decreased over the past ten years.

B. Children who are allergic to the chemicals are no more likely than other children to have allergies to other substances.

C. Children who have allergic reactions to the chemicals are not more likely to be sent to a school nurse now than they were ten years ago.

D. The chemicals are not commonly used as cleaners or pesticides in houses and apartment buildings in Renston.

E. Children attending elementary school do not make up a larger proportion of Renston's population now than they did ten years ago.

762. Lockeport's commercial fishing boats use gill nets, which kill many of the netted fish, including some fish of

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762. Lockeport's commercial fishing boats use gill nets, which kill many of the netted fish, including some fish of endangered species. The fishing commission has proposed requiring the use of tent nets, which do not kill fish; boat crews would then throw back fish of endangered species. Profitable commercial fishing boats in similar areas have already switched over to tent nets. The proposal can therefore be implemented without economic harm to Lockeport's commercial fishing boat operators.

Which of the following, if true, casts the most serious doubt on the argument made for the proposal?

A. In places where the use of tent nets has been mandated, there are typically fewer commercial fishing boats in operation than there were before tent nets came into use.

B. Even when used properly, gill nets require many more repairs than do tent nets.

C. Recreational anglers in Lockeport catch more fish of endangered species than do commercial fishing boats.

D. The endangered species of fish in Lockeport's commercial fishing area did not become endangered as a result of the use of gill nets by fishing fleets.

E. The endangered species of fish caught by Lockeport's commercial fishing fleet are of no commercial value.

763. Normally, the pineal gland governs a person's sleep-wake cycle by secreting melatonin in response to the daily cycle of light and darkness as detected by the eye. Nonetheless, many people who are totally blind due to lesions in the visual cortex of the brain easily maintain a 24-hour sleep-wake cycle. So the neural pathway by which the pineal gland receives information from the eye probably does not pass through the visual cortex.

For purposes of evaluating the argument, it would be most useful to establish which of the following?

A. Whether melatonin supplements help people who have difficulty maintaining a 24-hour sleep cycle to establish such a pattern

B. Whether the melatonin levels of most totally blind people who successfully maintain a 24-hour sleep-wake cycle change in response to changes in exposure to light and darkness

C. Whether melatonin is the only substance secreted by the pineal gland

D. Whether most people who do not have a 24-hour sleep-wake cycle nevertheless have a cycle of consistent duration

E. Whether there are any people with normal vision whose melatonin levels respond abnormally to periods of light and darkness

764. **In countries where automobile insurance includes compensation for whiplash injuries sustained in automobile accidents, reports of having suffered such injuries are twice as frequent as they are in countries where whiplash is not covered.** Presently, no objective test for whiplash exists, so it is true that spurious reports of whiplash injuries cannot be readily identified. Nevertheless, these facts do not warrant the conclusion drawn by some commentators that in the countries with the higher rates of reported whiplash injuries, half of the reported cases are spurious. Clearly, **in countries where automobile insurance does not include compensation for whiplash, people often have little incentive to report whiplash injuries that they actually have suffered.**

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first is a claim that the argument disputes; the second is a conclusion that has been based on that claim.

B. The first is a claim that has been used to support a conclusion that the argument accepts; the second is that conclusion.

C. The first is evidence that has been used to support a conclusion for which the argument provides further evidence; the second is the main conclusion of the argument.

D. The first is a finding whose implications are at issue in the argument; the second is a claim presented in order to argue against deriving certain implications from that finding.

E. The first is a finding whose accuracy is evaluated in the argument; the second is evidence presented to establish that the finding is accurate.

765. Last year Comfort Airlines had twice as many delayed flights as the year before, but the number of complaints from passengers about delayed flights went up three times. It is unlikely that this disproportionate increase in complaints was rooted in an increase in overall dissatisfaction with the service Comfort Airlines provides, since the airline made a special effort to improve other aspects of its service last year.

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Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the disproportionate increase in customer complaints?

A. Comfort Airlines had more flights last year than the year before.

B. Last year a single period of unusually bad weather caused a large number of flights to be delayed.

C. Some of the improvements that Comfort Airlines made in its service were required by new government regulations.

D. The average length of a flight delay was greater last year than it was the year before.

E. The average number of passengers per flight was no higher last year than the year before.

766. Last year a global disturbance of weather patterns disrupted harvests in many of the world's important agricultural areas. Worldwide production of soybeans, an important source of protein for people and livestock alike, was not adversely affected, however. Indeed, last year's soybean crop was actually slightly larger than average. Nevertheless, the weather phenomenon is probably responsible for a recent increase in the world price of soybeans.

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest justification for the attribution of the increase in soybean prices to the weather phenomenon?

A. Last year's harvest of anchovies, which provide an important protein source for livestock, was disrupted by the effects of the weather phenomenon.

B. Most countries that produce soybeans for export had above-average harvests of a number of food crops other than soybeans last year.

C. The world price of soybeans also rose several years ago, immediately after an earlier occurrence of a similar global weather disturbance.

D. Heavy rains attributable to the weather phenomenon improved grazing pastures last year, allowing farmers in many parts of the world to reduce their dependence on supplemental feed.

E. Prior to last year, soybean prices had been falling for several years.

767. Most of the year, the hermit thrush, a North American songbird, eats a diet consisting mainly of insects, but in autumn, as the thrushes migrate to their Central and South American wintering grounds, they feed almost exclusively on wild berries. Wild berries, however, are not as rich in calories as insects, yet thrushes need to consume plenty of calories in order to complete their migration. One possible explanation is that berries contain other nutrients that thrushes need for migration and that insects lack.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously calls into question the explanation given for the thrush's diet during migration?

A. Hermit thrushes, if undernourished, are unable to complete their autumn migration before the onset of winter.

B. Insect species contain certain nutrients that are not found in wild berries.

C. For songbirds, catching insects requires the expenditure of significantly more calories than eating wild berries does.

D. Along the hermit thrushes' migration routes, insects are abundant throughout the migration season.

E. There are some species of wild berries that hermit thrushes generally do not eat, even though these berry species are exceptionally rich in calories.

768. The kinds of hand and wrist injuries that result from extended use of a computer while maintaining an incorrect posture are common among schoolchildren in Harnville. Computers are important to the school curriculum there, so instead of reducing the amount their students use computers, teachers plan to bring about a sharp reduction in the number of these injuries by carefully monitoring their students' posture when using computers in the classroom.

Which of the following would it be most useful to know in order to assess the likelihood that the teachers' plan will be successful?

A. Whether extended use of a computer while maintaining incorrect posture can cause injuries other than hand and wrist injuries

B. Whether hand and wrist injuries not caused by computer use are common among schoolchildren in

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B. Whether hand and wrist injuries not caused by computer use are common among schoolchildren in Harnville

C. What proportion of schoolchildren in Harnville with hand and wrist injuries use computers extensively outside the classroom

D. Whether changes in the curriculum could reduce the schools' dependence on computers

E. What proportion of schoolchildren in Harnville already use correct posture while using a computer

769. A certain cultivated herb is one of a group of closely related plants that thrive in soil with high concentrations of metals that are toxic to most other plants. Agronomists studying the growth of this herb have discovered that it produces large amounts of histidine, an amino acid that, in test-tube solutions, renders these metals chemically inert. Hence, the herb's high histidine production must be the key feature that allows it to grow in metal-rich soils.

In evaluating the argument, it would be most important to determine which of the following?

A. Whether the herb can thrive in soil that does not have high concentrations of the toxic metals

B. Whether others of the closely related group of plants also produce histidine in large quantities

C. Whether the herb's high level of histidine production is associated with an unusually low level of production of some other amino acid

D. Whether growing the herb in soil with high concentrations of the metals will, over time, reduce their concentrations in the soil

E. Whether the concentration of histidine in the growing herb declines as the plant approaches maturity

770. Many people suffer an allergic reaction to certain sulfites, including those that are commonly added to wine as preservatives. However, since there are several winemakers who add sulfites to none of the wines they produce, people who would like to drink wine but are allergic to sulfites can drink wines produced by these winemakers without risking an allergic reaction to sulfites.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. These winemakers have been able to duplicate the preservative effect produced by adding sulfites by means that do not involve adding any potentially allergenic substances to their wine.

B. Not all forms of sulfite are equally likely to produce the allergic reaction.

C. Wine is the only beverage to which sulfites are commonly added.

D. Apart from sulfites, there are no substances commonly present in wine that give rise to an allergic reaction.

E. Sulfites are not naturally present in the wines produced by these winemakers in amounts large enough to produce an allergic reaction in someone who drinks these wines.

771. A new law gives ownership of patents—documents providing exclusive right to make and sell an invention—to universities, not the government, when those patents result from government-sponsored university research. Administrators at Logos University plan to sell any patents they acquire to corporations in order to fund programs to improve undergraduate teaching.

Which of the following, if true, would cast the most doubt on the viability of the college administrators' plan described above?

A. Profit-making corporations interested in developing products based on patents held by universities are likely to try to serve as exclusive

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